FIRST PROJECT MANUAL — CONFIDENTIAL

Indraprastha Heights

The Complete Beginner's Guide to Building & Selling Your First Project

End-to-end operating manual for a first-time developer: deal maths, land & title, UDCPR 2020 rules for a G+6 building, every NOC and approval, MahaRERA compliance, contractor selection and construction control, pricing, the full marketing and sales playbook, collections, handover, and the beginner mistakes that destroy first projects.

PROJECT
Indraprastha Heights

LOCATION
Plot 7B, SR 56, Dasak Shiwar

CONFIGURATION
Stilt Parking + 6 Floors

PRODUCT
2BHK & 3BHK

SALEABLE AREA
29,100 sq ft

AUTHORITY
Nashik Municipal Corporation

FRAMEWORK
UDCPR 2020 · MahaRERA · MOFA

PLOT
37.15m × 29.38m · Corner

Contents

Read Part A before spending another rupee. Parts B–F are execution.

1 Deal Structure, Break-Even & Survival Maths

The single page that decides whether this project makes or loses money

Before design, marketing or approvals — settle the arithmetic. In development, the deal structure decides profit far more than execution quality does. A well-built project on a bad structure still loses money.

1.1 — Your project's base numbers

PLOT AREA	SALEABLE AREA	BUILT-UP (APPROX)	CONFIG
~1,091	**29,100**	**~34,000**	**G+6**
sqm (37.15 × 29.38 m)	sq ft (per plan)	sq ft incl. common areas	stilt parking + 6 floors

1.2 — The break-even calculation (fill in YOUR real numbers)

STEP 1 — GROSS DEVELOPMENT VALUE (GDV)

GDV = Saleable area × Achievable rate

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Conservative: 29,100 × ₹3,800 = ₹11.06 Cr
Realistic: 29,100 × ₹4,200 = ₹12.22 Cr
Optimistic: 29,100 × ₹4,600 = ₹13.39 Cr
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STEP 2 — TOTAL PROJECT COST

Cost = Construction + Approvals + Finance + Marketing + Contingency

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Construction: 34,000 sqft × ₹2,200/sqft = ₹7.48 Cr
Govt fees, TDR/premium FSI, approvals = ₹0.80–1.20 Cr
Marketing + brokerage (4–5% of GDV) = ₹0.50–0.60 Cr
Finance cost + contingency (8%) = ₹0.70 Cr
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TOTAL COST ≈ ₹9.5–10.0 Cr

The number that decides everything — your share of GDV. If you are the developer on an area-sharing deal with the landowner, you fund 100% of construction but keep only your share of the flats. Run this before anything else:

Your share of saleable area	Your revenue @ ₹4,200/sqft	Your cost	Result
40% (11,640 sqft)	₹4.89 Cr	₹9.5 Cr	**LOSS ₹4.6 Cr**
60% (17,460 sqft)	₹7.33 Cr	₹9.5 Cr	**LOSS ₹2.2 Cr**
75% (21,825 sqft)	₹9.17 Cr	₹9.5 Cr	Break-even (approx)
85% (24,735 sqft)	₹10.39 Cr	₹9.5 Cr	Profit ₹0.9 Cr
100% (you own land)	₹12.22 Cr	₹9.5 Cr + land	Profit ₹2.7 Cr less land cost

1.3 — The rule to remember forever

The 2.5× Rule

An area-sharing development deal only works when the **achievable sale rate is at least 2.5–3× your construction cost per sqft**. Below that ratio, whatever you give away to the landowner comes straight out of your profit and then out of your capital.

- Dasak: sale ₹4,200 ÷ construction ₹2,200 = **1.9×** → area-sharing is dangerous
- Gangapur Rd: sale ₹6,500 ÷ ₹2,500 = **2.6×** → area-sharing works

At a 1.9× ratio you need **75%+ of the saleable area** to break even. If your current deal gives you less, renegotiate before you start — the four levers are on the next line.

1.4 — Four renegotiation levers (use before signing/starting)

Lever	How it works
Fixed-area deal	Landowner takes a fixed number of flats (e.g. 6 flats), not a %. Caps his share; all upside from better pricing is yours
Revenue share after cost	Split sale proceeds **after** project cost is recovered — construction burden shared proportionally, not dumped on you
Part-cash, lower area	Pay landowner some cash upfront in exchange for a much larger area share
Outright purchase	Buy the land if affordable — 100% of GDV is yours; simplest and most profitable structure

Verify your sale rate before finalising anything. Do not use my figures or a broker's claim. Go to **igrmaharashtra.gov.in → e-Search** and pull the last 6 months of actual registered flat transactions in Dasak Shiwar / Nashik Road. Registered prices are the truth; asking prices are marketing.

2 Cash Flow — How a First Project Gets Funded

Projects die of cash-flow timing, not of bad profit maths

You do not need ₹9.5 Cr in the bank. You need enough to reach the point where customer money starts arriving — and then the discipline to never spend ahead of it.

Stage	Cash needed from you	Money coming in
Approvals, NOCs, fees, RERA, architect	**₹80L–1.2 Cr** — all your money, zero income	Nil — you cannot legally book before RERA
Demolition + excavation + foundation	**₹60–90L**	Launch bookings begin: 10% booking amounts
Plinth to 2nd slab	₹1.2–1.8 Cr	Milestone demands (20–35% collected)
3rd slab to top slab	₹2.5–3 Cr	Bank disbursements start flowing (bulk of money)
Finishing, lifts, external	₹2–2.5 Cr	Milestone + possession-linked demands
OC + handover	₹30–50L	Final 5–10% on possession

> **The critical gap:** the first ₹1.5–2 Cr is entirely yours, spent over 8–14 months with no revenue. This is where most first-time developers run out. Arrange it before you start — not in month 9.

2.1 — Funding options, ranked for a first project

Source	Reality for a first-timer
Own capital	Cleanest. Budget the full pre-revenue ₹2 Cr from here if possible
Equity partner	Best first-project option — share risk, share profit. Structure in an SPV with written roles, capital, and exit terms
Construction finance (bank/ NBFC)	Hard without a track record. Needs sanctioned plan + RERA + clean title + 30–40% own contribution. Approach after RERA, not before
Customer advances	Your main engine — but 70% is legally locked in escrow (Section 9). Never plan on the full amount
Private/hand loans	Avoid. 2–3%/month interest destroys a 1.9× ratio project faster than any construction delay

3 The Team — Assemble Before Anything Else

Nine people. Hire slowly, verify credentials, put everything in writing

Role	Why essential	Cost
Architect (CoA registered)	Guru Buildcon — AutoDCR drawings, NOC coordination, completion certificate. Verify CoA number	1–2% of construction cost
Structural engineer (NMC licensed)	Design + stability certificates at every slab. Personally liable — cannot be skipped	₹1.5–3 L
Site engineer (full time)	Your eyes daily. A first-timer without one **will** be cheated on material and labour	₹30–45k/month
Advocate (property)	Title search, agreements, RERA, society formation, conveyance	₹1–2 L over project
Chartered Accountant	RERA CA certificates, escrow compliance, GST, TDS, quarterly filings	₹1–1.5 L/year
RCC contractor	Structure execution	See Section 11
Sales person	Site presence 7 days/week during launch. Do not staff the site with yourself alone	₹20–30k + 0.5% incentive
Liaison/consultant	Optional but valuable — walks files through NMC. Saves months	₹1.5–4 L
Bank DSA relationship	Converts buyers into loan approvals; a genuine sales channel	Free — they earn from the bank

Beginner tip: pay the architect and structural engineer properly and on time. They are the two people whose signatures the entire project legally rests on, and they will save you far more than they cost when NMC raises objections.

4 Land, Title & Ownership Verification

Everything below must be clean before you spend on drawings

4.1 — Documents to collect (in this order)

#	Document	Where	What to check
1	**7/12 Extract (certified)**	Talathi office / bhulekh.mahabhumi.gov.in	Owner name, area, **land class — NA or agricultural**, "Itar Hakk" (other rights) must be NIL, no mortgage/attachment
2	**Property Card**	City Survey Office, Nashik	Urban record — plot dimensions must match your plan (37.15 × 29.38 m)
3	**NA Order**	SDO, Nashik (if land is agricultural)	Without this, no building permission. 2–5 months. Check FIRST
4	**30-year title search**	Advocate at Sub-Registrar records	Every sale deed, mortgage, court case, acquisition notice, POA in the chain
5	**Index II (30 yrs)**	Sub-Registrar, Nashik Road	Cross-check against title report — any unexplained entry is a defect
6	**DP Remark / Zone Certificate**	NMC Town Planning	Zone (Residential R1/R2), any road widening or reservation on your plot
7	**Development Agreement + POA**	Registered at Sub-Registrar	Your area share, timelines, penalty clauses, who pays what — see Section 1.4
8	**Search report from a bank's panel advocate**	Via any bank	Free second opinion — if a bank's lawyer clears it, buyer home loans will clear too

4.2 — Site-specific issues on YOUR plot (from site inspection)

ISSUE 1 — EXISTING STRUCTURE

Old bungalow standing on the plot

Must be demolished. Budget ₹2–5 L. **Do not demolish before receiving the Commencement Certificate** — premature demolition invites notices and complicates the NMC site inspection. Salvage value (steel, timber, doors, bricks) offsets part of the cost; agree salvage rights in the demolition contract.

ISSUE 2 — TREES ON SITE

Mature trees are visibly present — Tree Authority NOC is mandatory

Do a tree survey now: count, species, girth, photographs. Trees above 100mm girth need formal permission. Expect a condition to plant 3 replacement trees per tree removed. **Apply in month 1 — this NOC takes 30–60 days and NMC will not sanction plans without it.** Cutting a tree without permission attracts heavy penalty and can stall the project.

ISSUE 3 — CORNER PLOT AT ROAD JUNCTION

Roads on both east and west sides — advantage and obligation

Advantage: two-side visibility, better marketing, corner-unit premium. Obligation: corner plots require a **splay/cut-off at the corner** as per UDCPR, and both facades must be finished — you cannot leave a "back side". Confirm the splay dimension with your architect before the plan is finalised.

Before you proceed: confirm the 9m west road and the east road are actually notified in the Development Plan and their widening lines are known. A proposed road that never gets built changes your setbacks, your FSI eligibility, and your marketing story.

5 Every Rule That Applies to a G+6 in Nashik

Unified Development Control & Promotion Regulations 2020 — the binding law

UDCPR 2020 (notified 5 Dec 2020) replaced all older DCRs for Maharashtra municipal corporations except Mumbai. Your architect must work from UDCPR 2020 — not the old Nashik DCR. Ask him to confirm this in writing.

Parameter	Rule	Applied to your plot
Basic FSI	1.10–1.50 depending on road width; 9m+ road qualifies for the higher slab	~1,636 sqm basic on 1,091 sqm plot
Additional FSI	TDR (up to +0.50) and Premium FSI on payment (up to +0.50)	**Essential** — your 29,100 sqft target needs ~2.4–2.5 FSI. Confirm the loading with Guru Buildcon
Ancillary/fungible FSI	Additional area on premium payment for balconies, service areas	Verify what is included in the 29,100 sqft figure
Ground coverage	Max ~40–45% of plot for residential	Max ~440–490 sqm footprint
Front setback	Min 3.0m; increases with building height	3.0–4.5m from the 9m road
Side/rear setbacks	Height-linked. For ~21m height, typically 4.5–6.0m unless relaxations apply	**Critical** — G+6 setbacks are much larger than G+4. Verify with architect
Marginal open space	Must be clear and accessible — cannot be built upon or fully covered	Fire tender access path required
Parking	1 ECS per flat minimum for units above 40 sqm carpet; visitor parking additional. 1 ECS ≈ 23 sqm incl. circulation	~20–24 flats → 20–24 ECS + visitor. Stilt alone may not suffice — check
Lift	Mandatory above G+3	Mandatory. For G+6 plan for **2 lifts** (or 1 lift + adequate stair) — 1 lift for 24 flats causes serious buyer objection
Staircase	Min 1.2m clear width residential; second staircase / fire escape as per height and fire NOC	Fire dept will likely require a second means of escape at this height
Corridor	Min 1.2m clear	Your plan shows 8'0" (2.4m) passage — compliant
Habitable room ventilation	Window area ≥ 1/10th of floor area; min room size norms apply	Check every bedroom in the plan
Rainwater harvesting	Mandatory for all new buildings in NMC	Show pit + roof drainage in drawings
Solar water heating	Mandatory for residential buildings above a stipulated number of flats	Show terrace solar provision
Waste management	Segregated waste storage; composting for larger projects	Provide a dry/wet waste room at stilt level
Water storage	Underground tank + overhead tank sized for occupancy; separate fire tank	Structural design must account for OHT load at G+6

Ask your architect for a written FSI statement — a single sheet showing: plot area, basic FSI, TDR loaded, premium FSI purchased, ancillary FSI, total permissible, total proposed, ground coverage %, parking count, setbacks on all four sides. If he cannot produce this in one page, the plan is not ready for submission.

6 The 24-Metre Rule — Your Costliest Design Decision

Read this before the plan is finalised. It can swing ₹40–80 lakh

The rule: Under Maharashtra fire regulations and the National Building Code, a residential building crossing **24 metres in height** is classified as a **high-rise**. High-rise classification triggers a dramatically more expensive compliance package.

6.1 — Do the height maths NOW

HEIGHT CALCULATION — GROUND LEVEL TO TERRACE SLAB

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Height = Stilt height + (Number of floors × Floor-to-floor height)
Conservative design: 3.0m stilt + (6 × 3.0m) = 21.0m → NOT high-rise ✓
Generous design: 3.3m stilt + (6 × 3.15m) = 22.2m → NOT high-rise ✓
Careless design: 3.6m stilt + (6 × 3.4m) = 24.0m → HIGH-RISE ✗
TARGET: keep total height at or below 22.5m — leave a safety margin
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6.2 — What changes if you cross 24m

Requirement	Below 24m	Above 24m (high-rise)	Extra cost
Fire lift	Not required	**Mandatory** — dedicated fireman's lift with power backup	₹12–20 L
Pressurised staircase	Not required	**Mandatory** — mechanical pressurisation system	₹8–15 L
Refuge area	Not required	**Mandatory** at prescribed levels — **consumes saleable area**	Area loss + ₹5 L
Sprinkler system	Generally not required	May be required throughout	₹15–25 L
Fire tank capacity	Lower	Substantially higher; larger pumps	₹5–10 L
Setbacks & fire tender path	Standard	Wider marginal spaces required — **may reduce your footprint**	Area loss
Approval complexity	Ward-level	Higher scrutiny, longer timelines	2–4 months delay

Action this week

Send one line to Guru Buildcon: **"Please confirm in writing the total building height from ground level to terrace slab, and confirm the building is classified as non-high-rise (below 24m) under the Maharashtra Fire Act."** Get the reply in writing before plan submission. If it comes back above 24m, reduce floor-to-floor heights to 2.95–3.0m — this single change protects ₹40–80 lakh and months of approval time, and buyers in this segment will never notice 5cm of ceiling height.

6.3 — Fire requirements you WILL have at G+6 (even below 24m)

- ☐ **Wet riser** — 100mm GI pipe vertical through all floors, landing valve each floor, Siamese connection at ground for fire brigade
- ☐ **Fire pumps** — electric main + diesel standby, typically 900+ LPM at 3.5 kg/cm², in a ground-level pump room with 24-hour access
- ☐ **Dedicated fire water tank** — separate from domestic supply, clearly marked (underground + terrace)
- ☐ **Hose reel cabinet** on every floor landing, 20m hose + nozzle, break-glass enclosure
- ☐ **Fire extinguishers** — ABC dry powder 5kg per 150 sqm floor area; CO_2 in electrical rooms
- ☐ **Smoke detection + alarm** in lobbies, common passages, electrical rooms — interconnected
- ☐ **Illuminated EXIT signage** with battery backup on all escape routes
- ☐ **Fire-rated doors (FD-60)** at lift lobby / staircase interface on each floor
- ☐ **Fire tender access** — a clear path and turning space per fire officer's requirement; this drives your setback design

☐ **Second means of escape** — confirm with the fire officer at drawing stage, not after construction

> **Budget:** ₹18–30 L for the complete fire package at G+6 (non-high-rise). Include it in your project cost from day one — first-timers routinely forget this and find it in month 20.

7 NOC Collection — Apply for ALL Simultaneously

The single biggest cause of first-project delay is applying one at a time

NOC	Office	Key documents	Time	Cost
Fire NOC (mandatory G+6)	Chief Fire Officer, NMC	Fire protection plan, escape route drawings, system specifications, staircase widths	30–60 days	Fee + ₹18–30L system
AAI height clearance	Online: nocas.aai.aero	Plot GPS coordinates, proposed height in metres, site plan	15–45 days	₹500–2,000
Tree Authority (confirmed needed)	NMC Tree Authority	Tree survey: count, species, girth, photos; replanting undertaking	30–60 days	Nominal + replanting
MSEDCL	MSEDCL Nashik Road sub-division	Load calculation (~4kW × flats + common), site plan, transformer requirement	15–30 days	Deposit at connection
Water & Drainage	NMC Water Dept, Nashik Road ward	Drainage layout, connection point, sewer availability confirmation	15–30 days	Betterment charges
MPCB / Environment	environs.maharashtra.gov.in	Construction waste plan, dust mitigation, project details	30–60 days	Fee based on area
Cantonment (verify)	Nashik Road / Deolali Cantonment Board	Only if plot falls in cantonment zone or buffer — **have your advocate confirm this in month 1**	30–90 days	Varies
Lift shaft approval	Lift Inspector, DISH Maharashtra	Shaft drawings — needed **before** constructing the shaft, not after	30–45 days	Nominal

7.1 — How to run NOCs without losing months

1. Make a one-page **NOC tracker**: NOC name · applied date · reference/inward number · officer name · expected date · status. Update weekly.
2. Submit **all applications in the same week**. They run in parallel; there is no dependency between them.
3. Visit each office **in person every 10 days**. In Nashik, physical follow-up moves files; email does not.
4. Always collect a **stamped inward receipt** for every submission. Without it, files "go missing".
5. When an objection is raised, get it **in writing** and respond in writing. Verbal objections have a way of changing.

> **Consider a liaison consultant.** For ₹1.5–4 L, an experienced NMC liaison consultant will walk your files, know which desk is stuck, and typically save 3–6 months. On a project of this size, 4 months saved is worth far more than the fee. Ask Guru Buildcon to recommend one they have worked with.

8 Building Plan Sanction (NMC AutoDCR)

Your architect submits; you control the fees and the follow-up

NMC processes building permissions through **AutoDCR**, which auto-checks drawings against UDCPR 2020. Drawings go in DXF/DWG with prescribed layer naming; wrong layers cause instant rejection.

8.1 — Drawing set required

Key plan (1:1000) · Site plan (1:200 or 1:500) · Stilt/parking plan · All floor plans (1:100) · Terrace plan · All 4 elevations · Minimum 2 sections · Parking layout with ECS marked · Drainage & plumbing layout · Rainwater harvesting plan · Solar provision · Fire protection plan · Structural drawings + soil report.

8.2 — Government fees to budget

Fee	Basis	Indicative
Development charges	Per sqm of built-up area	₹350–700/sqm
Infrastructure charges	Per sqm	₹200–400/sqm
Premium FSI charges	% of Ready Reckoner rate × additional area	Large — get exact figure
TDR purchase	Market rate	₹800–1,500/sqm of plot
Scrutiny fee	Built-up area based	₹20,000–80,000
Water/drainage betterment	Per flat	₹5,000–20,000/flat
Labour welfare cess	1% of construction cost	~₹7.5 L (paid during construction)
Total government outgo (estimate)		**₹60L–1.2 Cr**

> **Get the exact fee calculation from NMC in writing before you commit.** Premium FSI and TDR are the two biggest and most variable items — a wrong assumption here can move your project cost by ₹30–50 lakh.

9 MahaRERA — Non-Negotiable

No marketing, no booking, no rupee before your RERA number exists

> **Section 3, RERA Act 2016:** advertising, marketing, booking or selling without registration is an offence — fine up to 10% of project cost, imprisonment up to 3 years for continued violation. This includes WhatsApp broadcasts, hoardings, Instagram posts, and accepting a ₹51,000 "token".

Requirement	What you must do
Registration	maharera.mahaonline.gov.in — needs sanctioned plan, title documents, architect certificate, CA certificate, promoter KYC. Issued in ~30 days
Escrow account	Separate designated bank account. **70% of every rupee collected** goes here and can only be withdrawn against certificates from your engineer + architect + CA confirming % completion
Carpet area only	Sell and advertise on carpet area (excludes external walls, shafts, balconies). Super built-up pricing is illegal
Completion date	Declare conservatively. Delay = interest to buyers at SBI MCLR + 2% per month, plus refund rights
Agreement for Sale	Use the MahaRERA model format. Registered. Stamp duty 0.1% at booking stage
Quarterly updates	Construction photos + financials uploaded every quarter, throughout the project
Display RERA number	On every advertisement, hoarding, brochure, WhatsApp message, and website — legally required

Turn compliance into marketing. Many small builders in the Nashik Road belt operate without RERA. "RERA registered — MahaRERA No. P52xxxxxxxx" on your hoarding is a genuine trust differentiator with buyers who have heard delivery horror stories. Use it prominently.

10 Commencement Certificate & Demolition

The legal green light to break ground

SEQUENCE — DO NOT REORDER

Plan sanction → RERA → CC → demolition → excavation

1. Apply for CC to NMC Building Department with sanctioned plan + RERA certificate
2. NMC engineer inspects: plot boundaries match plan, setbacks physically marked with pegs/lime, no unauthorised work started
3. CC issued in 2–4 weeks
4. **Display the CC and approved plan on site** in a weatherproof frame — NMC requirement, and it reassures every visiting buyer
5. Now demolish the existing bungalow. Contract should specify: debris removal, salvage rights, safety barricading, and completion within 15 days
6. Site setup: boundary barricade with project branding, site office, water and power connection, storage shed, watchman quarters

11 Contractor Selection & Contract Structure

The decision that determines your cost, quality and sanity

11.1 — Three contract models

Model	How it works	Best for
Turnkey / lumpsum	Contractor supplies everything at a fixed ₹/sqft	Simplest, costliest (₹2,400–2,800/sqft). Quality risk if you don't supervise. Suits an absent developer
Labour rate	You buy all material; contractor supplies labour only	Cheapest and most control — but needs a full-time site engineer and daily procurement. High wastage risk if unmanaged
Hybrid (recommended)	You procure cement, steel, tiles, sanitaryware, lifts directly. Contractor does labour + minor materials, item-rate	**Best for a first project** — you control the 60% of cost that matters, contractor handles execution complexity

11.2 — Selecting the contractor

- ☐ Visit 3 of his completed buildings — look at plaster lines, plumbing chases, terrace waterproofing, staircase finish
- ☐ Talk to 2 past clients **without** the contractor present. Ask about delays, extra claims, labour disputes
- ☐ Confirm he has executed at least one G+5 or taller — G+6 needs proper scaffolding, hoisting and slab-cycle discipline
- ☐ Verify GST registration, PAN, and labour licence; ask for his ESIC/EPF registration numbers
- ☐ Take 3 written quotations on an identical BOQ — never compare verbal rates
- ☐ Check his current workload — a contractor running 4 sites will starve yours of labour

11.3 — Clauses your contract must contain

Clause	What it protects
Detailed BOQ + rates	Every item measured and priced. No "as per site" items
Stage-linked payment	Payment only against completed, measured, certified work. Never advance more than 5–10% mobilisation
Retention 5%	Held until 6 months after completion — your leverage on snags
Timeline + penalty	Per-slab cycle timeline (typically 21–28 days/slab), with a per-week delay penalty
Quality standards	Concrete grade, cube testing frequency, steel brand, curing period, tolerance limits
Labour compliance	Contractor responsible for ESIC, EPF, BOCW, safety, insurance — with certificates as a payment condition
Safety	Helmets, harnesses at height, scaffolding standards, net protection. A fatal accident at G+6 stops your project for months

Clause	What it protects
No sub-contracting	Without your written consent
Termination	Your right to terminate and take over materials if he abandons or delays beyond a threshold

12 Cost Control — Where First-Timers Lose 15%

Every leak below is preventable with a system

Leak	Typical loss	Control
Steel & cement pilferage	3–7%	Gate register for every delivery; weighbridge slips; daily consumption reconciliation against theoretical requirement; locked store with a single keyholder
Concrete wastage / over-ordering	2–4%	Pre-calculate volume per slab; use RMC with delivery challans; cube-test every pour
Design changes mid-construction	3–8%	Freeze drawings before starting. Every change after that costs 3× what it would have on paper
Rate escalation	4–10%	Lock cement and steel rates with dealers in bulk tranches; buy at dips; storage capacity pays for itself
Idle labour	2–5%	Material must be on site **before** the crew. Running out of sand on a plastering day costs a full day's wages
Rework	1–3%	Check level, line and plumb at every stage **before** the next trade starts
Finance cost from delays	Largest of all	Every month of delay is interest plus a month of overheads. Speed IS profit

The three registers that save a first project

- **Material inward register** — date, item, quantity, vehicle number, supplier challan number, receiver signature. No entry, no payment.
- **Daily progress report** — labour count by trade, work done, material consumed, issues. One WhatsApp message from your site engineer every evening.
- **Payment register** — every rupee paid, against which measured work, certified by whom. Reconciled monthly against the BOQ.

13 Specification Sheet for This Market

Match spec to buyer expectations — over-spec kills margin, under-spec kills sales

Element	Recommended spec (Dasak, ₹32–60L segment)
Structure	RCC framed, earthquake-resistant design per IS codes, M25 concrete for columns, Fe500D steel (branded — TATA/JSW/SAIL)
Walls	6" external / 4" internal AAC blocks or brickwork; gypsum or sand-faced plaster internally
Flooring	2×2 vitrified tiles (₹45–70/sqft) living/bedrooms; anti-skid ceramic in bathrooms/balcony
Kitchen	Granite platform, SS sink, glazed tile dado to 2ft above platform, provision for water purifier and chimney
Bathrooms	Tiles to door height, branded CP fittings (Jaquar/Cera entry range), concealed plumbing, EWC, provision for geyser
Doors	Main: decorative flush with safety lock and eye-piece. Internal: flush doors. Bath: WPC/PVC
Windows	Powder-coated aluminium or uPVC sliding with mosquito-net provision and MS safety grill
Electrical	Concealed copper (Polycab/Finolex), modular switches (Legrand/Anchor Roma), MCB box, AC points in all bedrooms + living, TV/internet points
Painting	Internal: putty + primer + emulsion. External: weather-shield exterior emulsion (Asian/Berger)
Lifts	**2 lifts strongly advised at G+6** — 6/8-passenger, branded (Johnson/Kone/Schindler), with ARD (auto rescue device) and power backup
Common areas	Granite/vitrified lobby, decorative entrance, staircase railing, common area lighting on a separate meter
Amenities (right-sized)	Stilt parking, security cabin, CCTV at entry + lobbies, intercom, children's play corner, terrace sit-out, borewell + tanker provision, DG backup for lift + common lights, solar water heating

Element	Recommended spec (Dasak, ₹32–60L segment)
External	Two-tone weatherproof texture finish, compound wall with gate, paved driveway, landscaping at entrance, project name signage

Where to spend extra (buyers notice): entrance lobby, lift quality and count, bathroom fittings, external elevation, and parking layout. **Where not to (buyers don't):** imported tiles, false ceilings, elaborate landscaping, a ₹8L sample flat. A clean, safe, well-signposted site with visible progress sells better than a show flat in this segment.

14 Quality & Statutory Checkpoints, Stage by Stage

Miss the statutory ones and your OC is blocked at the end

Stage	Quality checks	Statutory action
Excavation & foundation	Depth and soil match the soil report; footing dimensions per structural drawing; PCC level; anti-termite treatment; steel cover blocks	Structural engineer certificate
Plinth	Plinth level vs road level (flood safety); filling compaction in layers; plinth beam reinforcement	**Call NMC for plinth inspection BEFORE columns rise above plinth.** Get plinth completion certificate
Columns & slabs (each floor)	Column verticality (plumb); reinforcement as per drawing (count bars yourself); concrete cover; cube test per pour; curing for 7–14 days; shuttering quality	Structural engineer certificate for **each** slab; RERA quarterly photo upload
Lift shaft	Shaft plumb and dimensions exact — a 20mm error means a rejected lift	**Lift Inspector (DISH) shaft drawing approval BEFORE construction**
Blockwork	Line, level, plumb; proper curing; lintels over openings; no gaps at slab junction	—
Plumbing & electrical (concealed)	Pressure-test all plumbing BEFORE plastering; photograph every wall's conduit layout before covering	Licensed electrical contractor execution
Plastering	Thickness uniformity, curing, no hollowness (tap-test), corner beading	—
Waterproofing	Terrace, bathrooms, water tanks, external walls — **flood-test bathrooms for 48 hours before tiling**	—
Terrace & parapet	Slope towards drains, parapet ≥1.05m, tank foundations	Final structural stability certificate
Fire systems	Riser pressure test, pump performance, alarm testing	Fire department final inspection
Lift installation	Levelling accuracy, door operation, ARD test	Lift Inspector final certificate
Finishing	Tile levels and joints, door/window operation, paint finish, fitting alignment	—
Pre-handover	Snag list per flat, deep clean, all fittings tested	Architect completion certificate → OC application
Every quarter	—	**MahaRERA upload: photos + financials**. Missing these attracts penalty

Three things that cause OC rejection at the end: (1) any deviation from the sanctioned plan — build exactly as approved; (2) missing stage certificates from the structural engineer; (3) rainwater harvesting or solar not actually installed. All three are avoidable if you follow this table.

15 Positioning — What You Are Actually Selling

Get this right and everything else in marketing becomes easy

Your three genuine advantages

- **Proximity to Nashik Road railway station** — a real, permanent, verifiable advantage. Mumbai/Pune commuters, railway employees, and daily travellers pay for this. Lead every communication with it.
- **The tallest, most modern building in the neighbourhood** — surroundings are G+1 bungalows. Your G+6 with stilt parking, two lifts and CCTV is a genuinely different product class in Dasak. You are not competing with the flats around you; there aren't any.
- **Corner plot with roads on two sides** — better light, better ventilation, better resale. The proposed 9m road is a future value story you can document with the DP map on your site board.

What NOT to claim. Do not use "luxury", "premium", "world-class", or "elite". Buyers in this segment dismiss it instantly and it damages credibility. Your words are: **safe, spacious, well-built, RERA registered, near station, ready on time.**

15.1 — Positioning statement (use this everywhere)

Indraprastha Heights — Dasak, Nashik Road.
Spacious 2BHK & 3BHK homes, minutes from Nashik Road Railway Station.
Stilt parking · 2 lifts · CCTV security · RERA registered.
Built by people who live here, for families who want to.

16 Pricing Strategy & Escalation Ladder

Price low at launch to create momentum, then climb

Before setting price: pull the last 6 months of **registered** transactions for Dasak Shiwar / Nashik Road from igrmaharashtra.gov.in, and visit 5 competing projects as a buyer to note their quoted rate, what's included, and how many flats they've sold. Price against reality, not hope.

16.1 — Indicative pricing (validate with the above)

Unit	Carpet area	Launch price	Rate/sqft carpet
2BHK	620–700 sqft	₹31–38 L	₹4,800–5,400
2BHK (corner/large)	700–760 sqft	₹37–43 L	₹5,100–5,600
3BHK	900–1,000 sqft	₹48–58 L	₹5,200–5,800

Plus: stamp duty and registration (buyer), GST (1% if affordable-housing criteria met, else 5%), one-time maintenance deposit, and parking/floor-rise as per your price list.

16.2 — The escalation ladder (this is how developers make money)

Stage	Inventory released	Price	Why buyers accept it
Soft launch (post-RERA)	25–30%	Base price	"Founder rate" — earliest buyers get the best price and best units
Plinth complete	+20%	+4–6%	Visible progress, risk reduced
3rd slab	+20%	+8–12%	Building is visible from the road; credibility established
Top slab / brickwork	+20%	+15–18%	Near-ready product
OC / ready possession	Remaining	+20–25%	Zero risk, zero GST, immediate move-in

16.3 — Price-list add-ons (standard practice, budget them in)

- ☐ **Floor rise:** ₹25–50/sqft per floor above 2nd — top floors have terrace access appeal here
- ☐ **Corner/east-facing premium:** ₹50,000–1,50,000 per unit
- ☐ **Covered parking:** price into the flat rather than selling separately (RERA-safer)
- ☐ **Maintenance deposit:** 12–24 months advance, transferred to the society at formation
- ☐ **Never discount the headline price** — give a free modular kitchen, waived floor-rise, or paid stamp duty instead. A discounted rate resets the value for every future buyer

17 Phase 1 — Pre-Launch (Before RERA Number)

What you can legally do while approvals are running

Hard legal line. Before your RERA number: no prices, no unit sizes, no bookings, no tokens, no "block your flat". You may only build brand awareness. Breaking this is a criminal offence and gives a competitor an easy complaint to file against you.

17.1 — Permitted pre-launch activities

Activity	Detail	Cost
Site board	"Coming Soon — Indraprastha Heights — 2 & 3 BHK — Dasak" + phone. At a two-road junction this works 24×7. Your single best spend	₹8–15k
Brand assets	Logo, name registration, elevation render, project identity	₹25–50k
Google Business Profile	Create "Indraprastha Heights", category: Real Estate Developer, add photos, address, phone	Free
Social pages	Instagram + Facebook. Post construction-prep, site clearing, plan approval milestones. Build a following before you need it	Free
Broker relationships	Meet 10–15 brokers in Nashik Road/Dasak. Explain the project, take their numbers. No prices discussed — just relationship building	Chai money
Interest list	Collect names and numbers of interested people, with a written note that no booking is being accepted until RERA registration	Free
Bank tie-ups	Start conversations with SBI, BoB, HDFC, Saraswat for project approval. Takes months — start early	Free

18 Phase 2 — Launch (RERA Number in Hand)

Now everything switches on at once

18.1 — Launch checklist

- ☐ RERA number printed on **every** piece of material — hoarding, flyer, WhatsApp, social post, brochure
- ☐ Price list finalised: unit-wise carpet area, price, floor rise, payment schedule
- ☐ Payment schedule prepared (booking 10% → agreement 20% → plinth → each slab → finishing → possession)
- ☐ Brochure/flyer printed — 1 page, Marathi + English, floor plan, EMI figure, location map, RERA number
- ☐ Site office ready — table, chairs, drinking water, plan display, elevation render, price list
- ☐ Sales person appointed and trained on the script (Section 21)
- ☐ Hoarding at Nashik Road station exit booked
- ☐ Model Agreement for Sale drafted by advocate (MahaRERA format)
- ☐ Escrow account opened and mapped in RERA
- ☐ 2–3 bank DSAs briefed and ready to process loans

18.2 — Launch offer (creates urgency without discounting)

```
LAUNCH OFFER — First 8 bookings only
• Stamp duty waived (worth ₹2,00,000+)  OR  Free modular kitchen
• No floor-rise charges
• Preferred unit selection
```

• Booking amount only ₹51,000
Offer valid till [date, 21 days out] or first 8 bookings, whichever is earlier.

Why this works: a fixed number and a fixed date create genuine scarcity; you protect your headline rate; and the early buyers become your referral engine.

18.3 — Launch event (Sunday, 10am–5pm)

Do a simple, credible site event: clean barricaded site, banner, plan display board, chai and poha, 2–3 chairs under a shamiana, your architect present for 2 hours to answer technical questions, and a small pooja at 10am. Invite the interest list, all brokers, and boost a Facebook/Instagram event post in a 10km radius. Target: 40–60 visitors, 3–6 bookings.

19 Channel Partners — 40% of Your Sales

Brokers are not a cost; they are your distribution network

In the Nashik Road market, local brokers control a large share of buyer flow. A first-time developer without a broker network sells slowly. Build this network deliberately.

19.1 — The channel partner programme

Element	Standard
Brokerage	**2%** of agreement value (competitive in this belt). Pay 50% on agreement registration, 50% on 30% collection
Launch bonus	Extra ₹15,000 per booking for the first 10 bookings — creates a rush at launch
Payment discipline	**Pay within 7 days, every time.** Brokers sell what pays fastest. Late payment is why builders lose channel loyalty
Registration	Simple form: name, firm, phone, PAN, bank details. Give a signed appointment letter
Lead protection	Broker registers the client's name/number by WhatsApp before the site visit; valid 30 days. Written policy prevents disputes
Support	WhatsApp group with all partners: price list, availability, construction photos, offers. Update weekly

19.2 — Broker outreach message

Namaskar [Name] ji,

Indraprastha Heights — Dasak, Nashik Road. Now RERA registered.
MahaRERA No: [number]

• 2BHK & 3BHK · Stilt parking · 2 lifts · CCTV
• Walking distance from Nashik Road station
• 2BHK from ₹__ L | 3BHK from ₹__ L
• Brokerage 2% + ₹15,000 bonus on first 10 bookings
• Payment within 7 days of agreement — guaranteed

Site visit any day, 10am–6pm. Shall I share the floor plan and price list?

— [Your name], [phone]

20 Digital Marketing — Exact Setup

₹15–25k/month generates more enquiries than ₹1L of print in this market

Channel	Setup	Monthly budget
WhatsApp Business	Catalogue with floor plans, price list, photos. Auto-greeting. Broadcast list segmented: enquiries / brokers / booked customers	Free
Meta ads (FB+Insta)	Lead-form ads. Radius: 10km from Nashik Road station. Age 27–50. Interests: home loan, real estate. Creative: elevation render + "2BHK from ₹__L near Nashik Road station"	₹8–15k
Google Business Profile	Weekly photo posts of construction progress. Ask every booked customer for a review	Free
YouTube	Monthly 60-second progress video shot on a phone. Walk the site, narrate in Marathi. Share to WhatsApp — this single habit builds enormous trust	Free
Property portals	99acres / MagicBricks / Housing listing once RERA is live	₹5–10k
Google Search ads	Optional later. Keywords: "flats in nashik road", "2bhk nashik road", "flats near nashik road station"	₹5–8k

20.1 — Ad copy that works in this market

```
2BHK near Nashik Road Station — ₹__ Lakhs onwards

MahaRERA Registered
Stilt parking + 2 lifts + CCTV
Home loan assistance available
EMI starting ₹__,___ per month

Dasak, Nashik Road
Site visit: [number]
```

Marathi version: नाशिक रोड स्टेशनजवळ 2BHK — ₹__ लाखांपासून
महारेरा नोंदणीकृत | स्टिल्ट पार्किंग | 2 लिफ्ट | सीसीटीव्ही
साईट व्हिजिटसाठी संपर्क: [number]

20.2 — Offline that still works here

Hoarding at Nashik Road station exit (highest-ROI offline spend — your target buyer walks past it twice daily) · **Site barricade branding** (free, permanent, 24×7) · **Auto-rickshaw branding** on 4–5 autos on the Dasak route (₹1,500–2,500/auto/month) · **Pamphlet insert** in local Marathi newspapers in a 5km radius · **Society/samaj notice boards** and railway employee associations.

21 Site Visit to Booking — The Conversion Process

Enquiries are worthless; conversion is everything

21.1 — The funnel and the targets to hold yourself to

Stage	Target conversion	What drives it
Enquiry → Site visit	>30%	Call within 10 minutes of the lead arriving. Speed is the entire game
Site visit → Second visit (with family)	>50%	Nobody buys alone. Your goal on visit 1 is to get the spouse/parents to visit
Second visit → Booking	>25%	Loan eligibility confirmed + offer deadline + a specific unit held
Booking → Registered agreement	>90%	Follow-up discipline; loan file moved fast
Cost per booking	<₹25,000	Track marketing spend ÷ bookings monthly

21.2 — The site visit script (train your salesperson on this)

```
1. WELCOME (2 min)
  Water, sit down, ask where they're from and what they do.
  "Aap kis area mein rehte ho abhi? Kaam kahaan hai?"

2. QUALIFY BEFORE PITCHING (5 min)
  • Budget range?
  • 2BHK or 3BHK?
  • Loan or self-funded? Which bank?
  • First home or upgrade?
  • Who else will decide? (spouse/parents — CRITICAL)
  • Timeline to buy?

3. SHOW — location first, product second (15 min)
  • Distance to station, school, market, hospital
  • Both roads, the future 9m road on the DP map
  • Plan display: walk them through THEIR unit type
  • Stilt parking, 2 lifts, CCTV, security
  • RERA certificate on the wall — point at it

4. THE THREE TRUST PROOFS
  • "MahaRERA registered — number is on every paper we give you"
  • "Approved plan is displayed on site, you can see it any time"
  • "70% of your money goes to a designated project account by law"

5. NUMBERS (5 min)
  • Total price → down payment → loan amount → EMI
  • "Aapka EMI approx ₹__,___ aayega. Abhi rent kitna de rahe ho?"
  • Payment schedule linked to construction stages

6. CLOSE
  • "Is unit ko main aapke naam pe 48 ghante hold kar sakta hoon."
  • "Launch offer [date] tak hai — uske baad rate badhega."
  • Ask for the second visit with family, fix day and time NOW

7. AFTER THEY LEAVE — same day
  • WhatsApp: floor plan + price sheet + 3 site photos + your name
  • Save their number with a tag (2BHK-hot / 3BHK-warm)
  • Follow up on day 2, day 5, day 10. Most bookings come on follow-up 3–5
```

22 Booking Documentation, Collections & Home Loans

Getting the money in, legally and on time

22.1 — Booking to agreement sequence

1. **Booking form + amount** (₹51,000 or 2%) → issue a numbered receipt. Collect PAN, Aadhaar, photos of all buyers
2. **Allotment letter** within 7 days — unit number, carpet area, price, payment schedule, RERA number
3. **Agreement for Sale** within 30–45 days, in the MahaRERA model format, drafted by your advocate
4. **Registration** at the Sub-Registrar — buyer pays stamp duty (0.1% at this stage) + registration fee
5. **Loan file** — hand over to your DSA the day the agreement is registered; a bank needs the registered agreement to disburse
6. **Escrow discipline** — 70% of every receipt into the designated account, same day

22.2 — Payment schedule (construction-linked, RERA compliant)

Milestone	%	Cumulative
On booking	10%	10%
On agreement registration	20%	30%
On completion of plinth	15%	45%
On 2nd slab	10%	55%
On 4th slab	10%	65%
On 6th slab / top slab	10%	75%
On brickwork & plaster	10%	85%
On flooring & finishing	10%	95%
On possession (after OC)	5%	100%

22.3 — Collections discipline (where first-timers bleed)

- ☐ Raise the demand letter the **same day** a milestone is certified — not a week later
- ☐ WhatsApp the demand with a photo of the completed milestone. It converts far better than a bare letter
- ☐ Follow up on day 7, day 15, day 21. Charge the interest clause on delays — waive it as a goodwill gesture only after it has been raised
- ☐ For loan cases, chase the **bank**, not just the buyer — disbursement delay is usually a missing document at the branch
- ☐ Never hand over keys or allow interior work before full payment and OC. Once a buyer is inside, your leverage is gone

PMAY: check current scheme eligibility for your 2BHK buyers with your bank DSA. Where applicable, subsidy meaningfully reduces the effective EMI and is a strong closing tool for first-time buyers in this segment.

23 Occupancy Certificate & Possession

Without OC, nothing you built is legally habitable

Documents for OC: architect's completion certificate · structural engineer's stability certificate · fire department final NOC · lift inspector certificate · rainwater harvesting completion · solar installation certificate · electrical test certificate · NMC water/drainage confirmation. NMC then inspects every floor against the sanctioned plan. Minor deviations may be compounded on payment; major deviations require demolition.

Possession sequence: OC received → snag rectification per flat → final payment collected → possession letter + keys handed over with a signed handover checklist → final sale deed registered (buyer pays full stamp duty) → individual MSEDCL meters → property tax registration per flat.

24 Society, Conveyance & Defect Liability

Your obligations do not end at handover

Obligation	Requirement
Society formation	Form the co-operative housing society once the majority of flats are sold/occupied. Register with the District Deputy Registrar. Hand over the corpus and maintenance deposits with accounts
Conveyance	Execute the conveyance deed transferring land and building to the society. Delay here is the single biggest source of builder–society litigation in Maharashtra. Do it promptly
Defect liability	**RERA Section 14(3): 5 years from possession.** Any structural or workmanship defect reported must be rectified within 30 days at your cost. Budget a 1–1.5% retention for this — do not treat the project as closed at handover
Documents to hand over	OC, approved plans, completion certificates, lift & fire certificates, equipment warranties, AMC contacts, society registration papers

25 12 Mistakes That Kill First Projects

Every one of these has ended a first-time developer in Maharashtra

#	Mistake	Prevention
1	Starting with a deal structure below the 2.5× rule	Section 1. Fix the structure before the foundation
2	Underestimating pre-revenue cash need	Arrange the full ₹1.5–2 Cr before month 1
3	Marketing or taking tokens before RERA	Criminal offence. Wait for the number
4	Crossing 24m height unknowingly	Section 6. Get it in writing from your architect this week
5	Applying NOCs one at a time	All applications in the same week
6	Building even slightly differently from the sanctioned plan	OC gets blocked. Build exactly as approved
7	No full-time site engineer	You will be cheated on material and quality. Non-negotiable hire
8	Large advances to the contractor	Pay only against measured, certified work. Max 10% mobilisation
9	Mixing project money with personal/other accounts	RERA violation and you will lose track of true cost. One project, one account
10	Discounting the headline rate under pressure	Give freebies instead. A cut rate resets value for every future buyer
11	Ignoring collections while focused on construction	Demand letters same day as milestone; chase weekly. Cash flow kills faster than costs
12	Selling all inventory early at launch price	Hold 25–30% for the escalation ladder. Late-stage sales carry your profit

26 Master Timeline

Approvals 8–14 months · Construction 24–30 months · Total ~3.5 years to handover

Month 0–1	Verify deal structure & break-even. 7/12, property card, title search. Check NA status. Confirm height <24m in writing. Tree survey. Appoint structural engineer, order soil test.
Month 1–3	ALL NOC applications submitted same week (Fire, AAI, Tree, MSEDCL, Water, MPCB). AutoDCR drawings prepared. NA order if required. Arrange pre-revenue funding.
Month 3–5	NOCs chased weekly. Plan submitted on AutoDCR. Government fees paid. Pre-launch branding: site board, Google profile, social pages, broker relationships.
Month 5–8	NMC scrutiny, objections cleared, **Building Plan Sanction received**. Bank project approvals initiated. Contractor selection and BOQ tendering.
Month 8–10	**MahaRERA registration**. Escrow opened. CC applied and received. Demolition. Site setup. **LAUNCH** — price list, brochure, hoarding, brokers activated, digital ads live.
Month 10–13	Excavation and foundation. Plinth. **NMC plinth inspection**. Price escalation step 1. Target: 25–30% inventory booked.
Month 13–26	Slab cycles (21–28 days each). Structural certificate per slab. Lift shaft approval. RERA quarterly uploads. Monthly progress videos. Price escalation at 3rd and top slab. Target: 60–70% booked.
Month 26–34	Blockwork, plaster, waterproofing, flooring, fittings, lifts, fire systems, external painting, compound and landscaping. Collections chased hard.
Month 34–38	Fire final inspection, lift certificate, **OC application and inspection**. Snag rectification. OC received.
Month 38–42	Possession and final sale deeds. MSEDCL meters. Society formation. Conveyance. RERA project closure. Defect liability period begins (5 years).

The 90-Day Action Plan — start here

- ☐ **Week 1:** Run the break-even table in Section 1 with your actual area share. If below 75%, renegotiate before anything else.
- ☐ **Week 1:** Pull the 7/12 from bhulekh.mahabhumi.gov.in — confirm NA status. Appoint your advocate for the title search.
- ☐ **Week 1:** Email Guru Buildcon: written confirmation of total building height (<24m), a one-page FSI statement, and the setback drawing for G+6.
- ☐ **Week 2:** Verify actual sale rates on igrmaharashtra.gov.in. Visit 5 competing projects as a buyer. Fix your price band.
- ☐ **Week 2:** Tree survey with photographs. File the Tree Authority application.
- ☐ **Week 2–3:** Appoint structural engineer. Order soil investigation (3–4 bore holes).
- ☐ **Week 3–4:** All NOC applications submitted in the same week. Start the NOC tracker.
- ☐ **Week 4:** Site board up at the junction. Google Business Profile created. Instagram and Facebook pages live.
- ☐ **Week 5–8:** AutoDCR drawings finalised and reviewed. Government fee estimate obtained from NMC in writing.
- ☐ **Week 6–10:** Meet 15 brokers. Approach 3 banks for project approval. Line up pre-revenue funding.
- ☐ **Week 8–12:** Plan submitted. NOCs chased in person every 10 days. Contractor shortlist and BOQ prepared.

The five things that decide whether this project succeeds

- **The deal structure** — 75%+ of saleable area, or renegotiate
- **Pre-revenue capital** — ₹1.5–2 Cr arranged before month 1
- **Speed of approvals** — parallel NOCs and a liaison consultant save 6 months of interest

- **Collections discipline** — demand the day the milestone is certified, chase weekly
- **Building exactly as sanctioned** — the only guaranteed path to OC